The Last Ranger of Vanguard-7

By sachin rathore

The heat shimmered off the salt flats of the Thar Desert Spaceport, a vast expanse of white dust under a dual-sun sky. Sachin climbed the gantry with a steady heart, his Star Command suit gleaming in white, teal, and magenta. Before stepping into the airlock of the Vanguard-7, he turned back to the horizon. He gave a sharp, brave salute to the

Inside the cockpit, the atmosphere was a focused hum of high technology. Sachin settled into the pilot's chair, his hands moving with practiced precision. He flicked heavy physical toggles to prime the engines while his eyes tracked the shimmering holographic displays dancing before him. "Crystal Drive at eighty percent," he whispered.

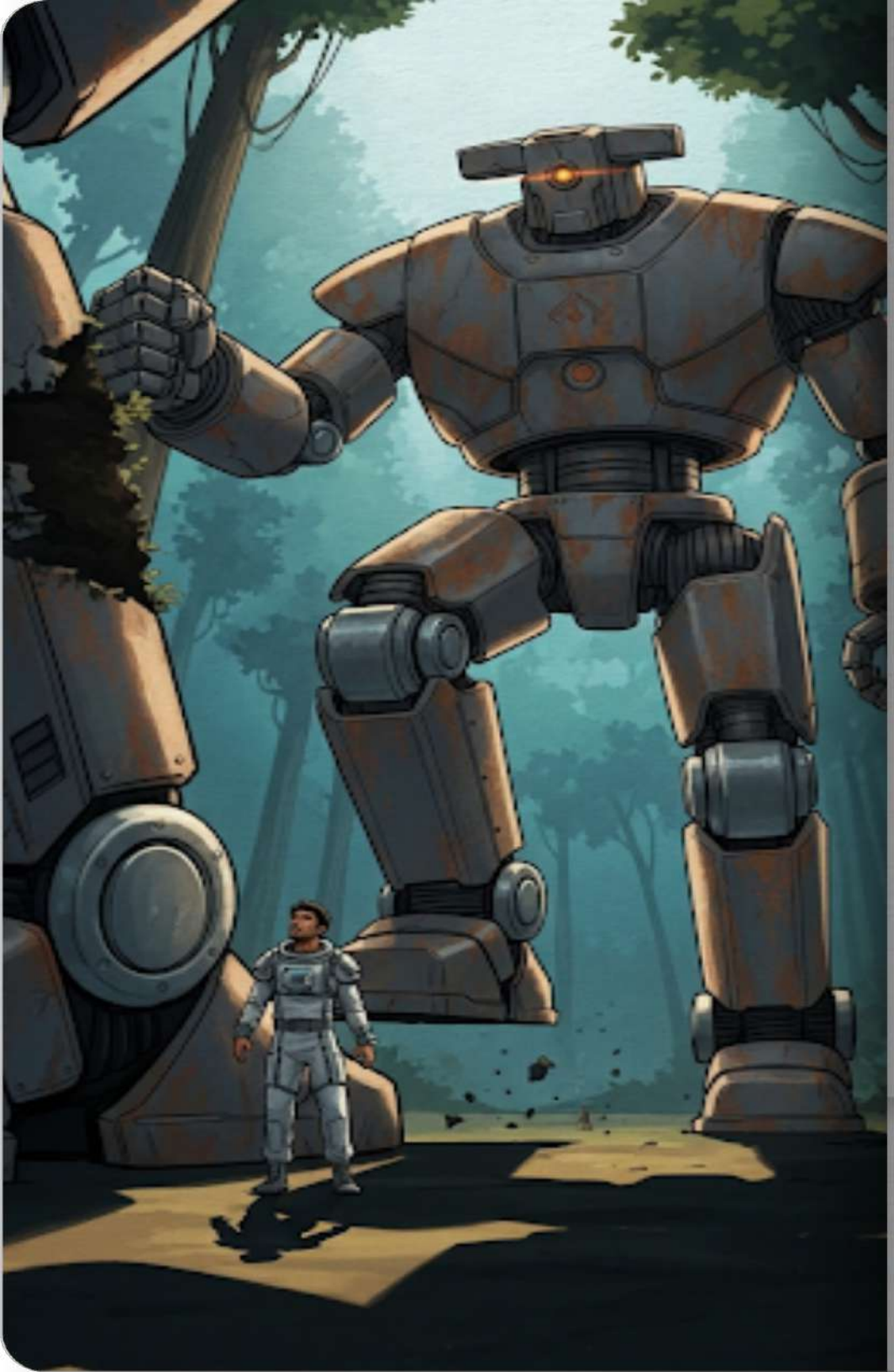
Then, the universe broke. As Sachin engaged the final sequence, a violent tremor ripped through the ship. Instead of the smooth jump to hyperspace, a jagged temporal rift tore open across the stars. A blinding, turbulent purple light flooded the cockpit, drowning out the alarms. Sachin gripped the flight stick,

The crash was a symphony of screaming metal and thunder. When the world finally went still, the Vanguard-7 lay like a broken bird in a dark, humid crater. Sachin kicked the emergency release, the hatch hissing open to reveal a world that shouldn't exist. He stumbled out into the wreckage, his suit scuffed and covered in

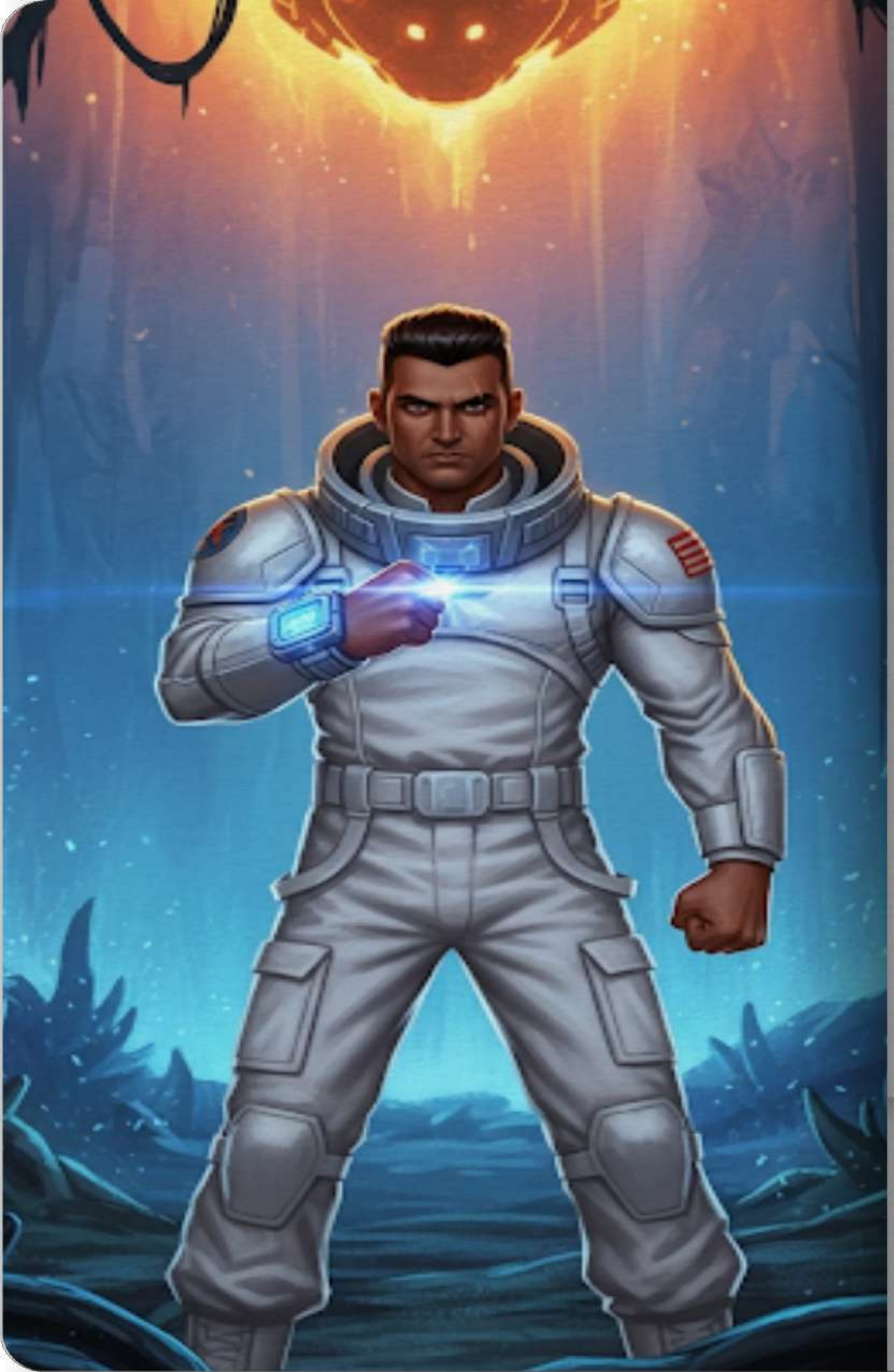
This was not the desert. Sachin found himself in a dense, alien jungle where the air tasted of ozone and ancient rain. Towering trees blocked the sky, and the ground was carpeted in thick ferns that pulsed with an eerie, bioluminescent blue glow. Every step he took left a shimmering footprint in the moss. The silence was heavy, broken only by the

As he hacked through a wall of thick, oily vines, Sachin stopped dead. Half-buried in the mud was a massive stone plaque. He knelt, wiping away decades of moss and grime with his gloved hand. His heart sank as the golden crest of the Star Command Academy emerged. It was weathered, cracked, and overtaken by the forest, looking as though

He checked his wrist-computer, his fingers trembling. The internal chronometer had finally synced with the local planetary beacon. The date on the screen was impossible. He hadn't just traveled across the galaxy; he had jumped eighty years into the future. The Academy, the desert spaceport, and everyone he had ever known were gone,



The ground began to vibrate. A rhythmic, bone-shaking thud echoed through the canopy, toppling smaller trees. Sachin looked up, his breath catching in his throat. A massive shadow blotted out the blue glow of the forest. It was a Sentinel, a fifty-foot-tall robotic war machine, its rusted joints screaming as it marched through the



Sachin stood his ground. He didn't hide, and he didn't run. He felt a new, cold resolve harden in his chest. He tightened the seals on his gloves, and his wrist-computer flared with a brilliant, steady blue light as he overrode the emergency protocols. He was the last Ranger of the Vanguard-7, and his mission wasn't over. It had only just begun. "I'm